

Bert and the Wheel of Worlds

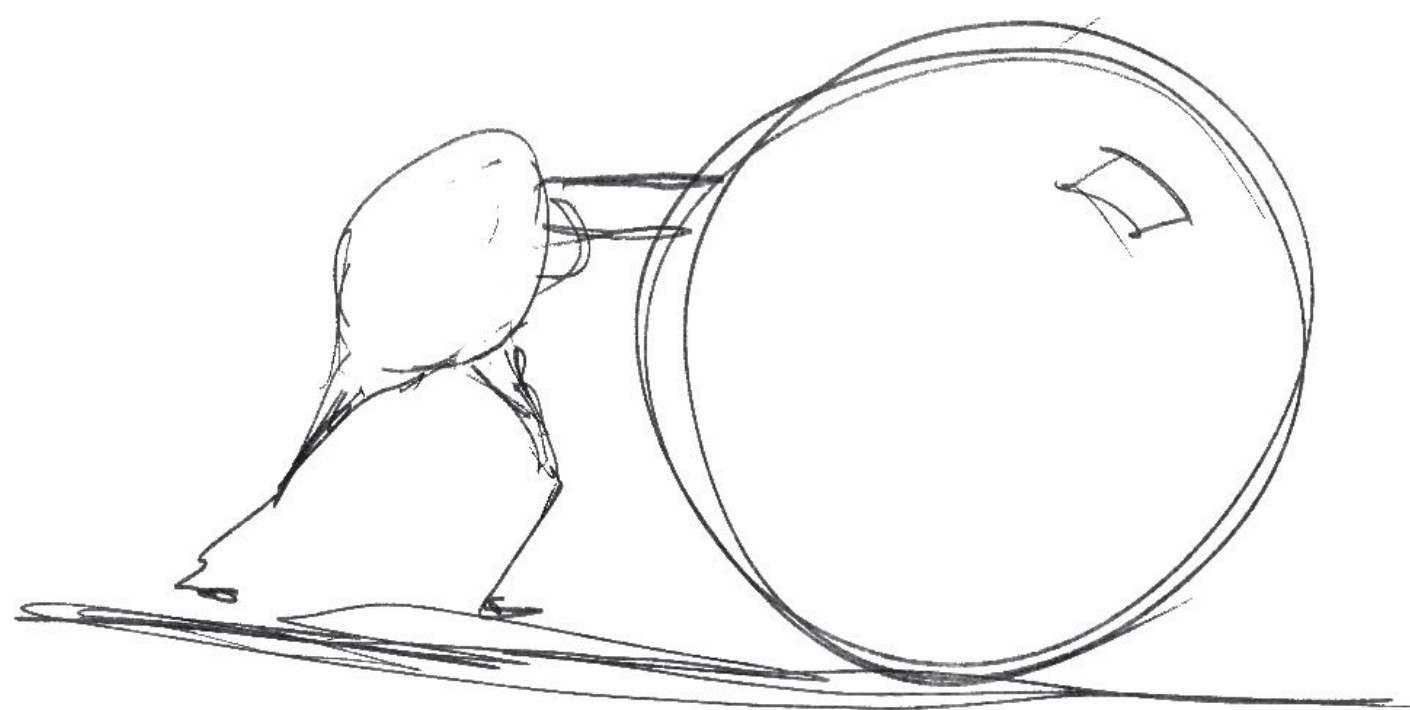
- physics puzzle (2D platformer)
- color focused, painted art
- parallel world switching
- scary SMB3 fish monsters
- whimsical vibes, soft synth or lo-fi music (80s not chiptune)
- 7 levels

fluid animation

sketchy penciled style?

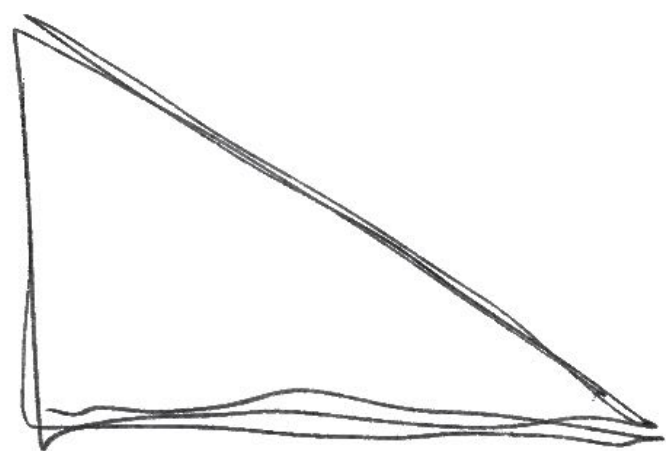
or smoother, illustrated?

awkward, clumsy, gangly



Bart? Hue?
Hugh?

physics puzzles



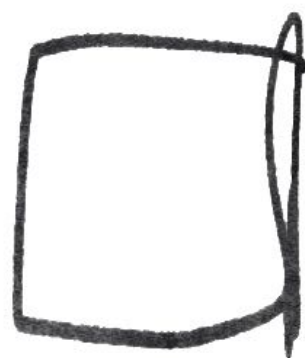
jumping on the
ramp at the
corner could flip it?

(could just be the plank?)

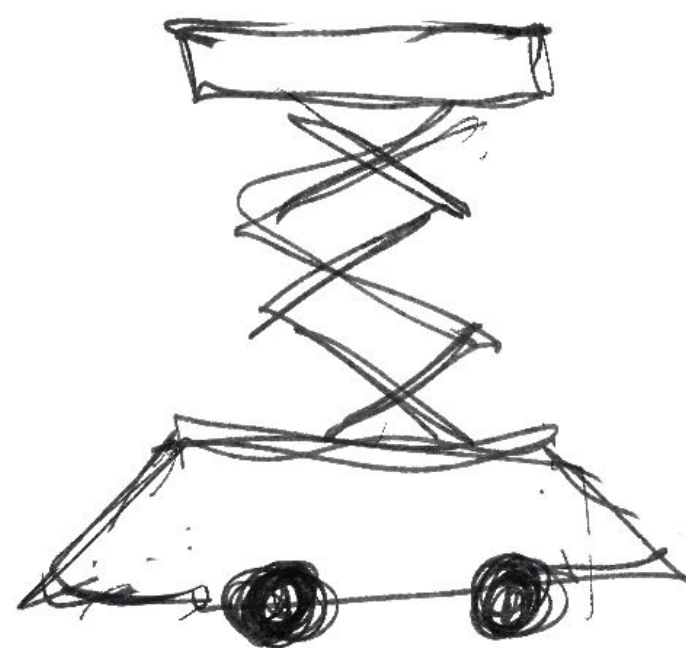


jump to launch the orb

can you pick up the
plank? what is the fulcrum?



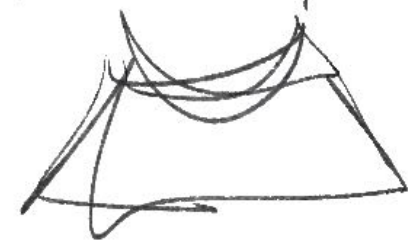
stone



lift

how do you
activate?

→ we'll need
an "activate"
control input



warp / teleport

warp

GOAL

- align orbs in the same location to open portal
- at first this means bringing new orbs to the same spot where you entered the world
- after a few levels you have to go back and start moving the previous orbs to other places because the new ones can't get back with the tools you have
- unlock new areas in previous worlds by reading new places in other worlds and then warping back

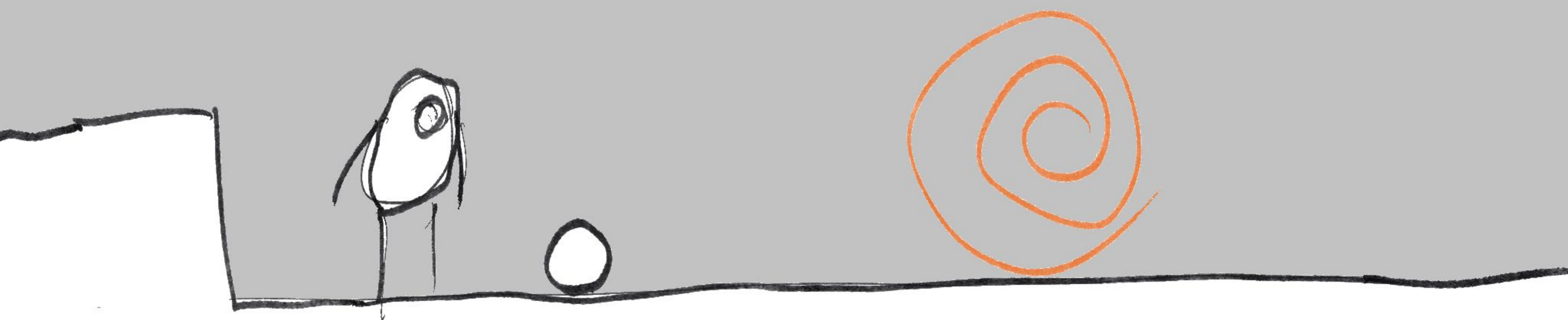
can you warp between worlds at will?
or do you need a device or skill?
limited # of uses? cooldown?

monsters

- feel like the fish from SMB3
- can impact ~~same~~ props (eg. plank)
but maybe not heavy ones (eg. stone)
- devices to fight back?
eg. drop stone from lift?
- push orb or eat it?
- props that drop in the water reset to
original position
- intermittent threat - they need to
leave you alone and then come back

as can stop
if moving at
speeds

world 1 (tutorial on movement)



sample
orb?

portal

tutorial

white? gray?

world 2 - no threat, learn to use
plank and align orbs



use
plank
to align
orange
orb

ghosting
to indicate
other orb



portal appears
when rrb's are
aligned

old item (plank)

World 3

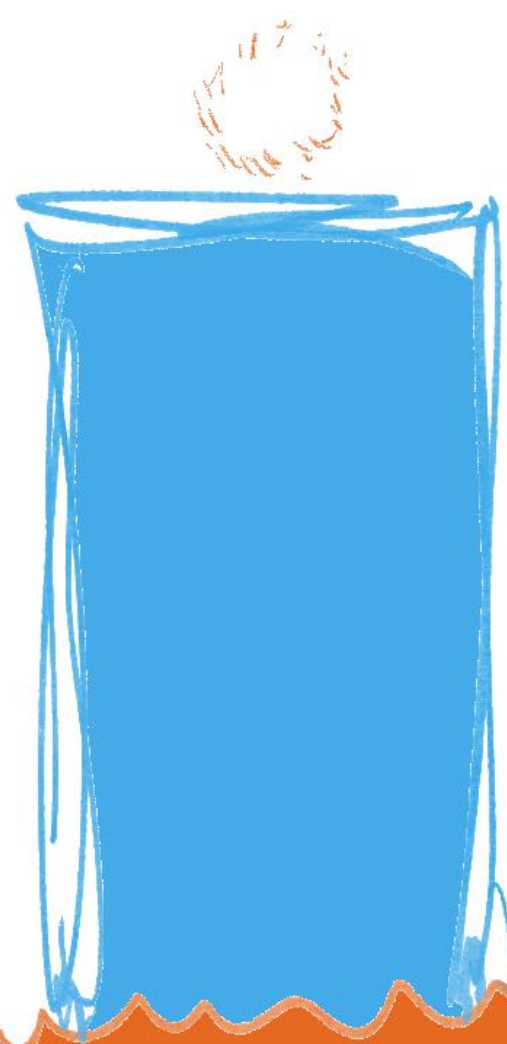
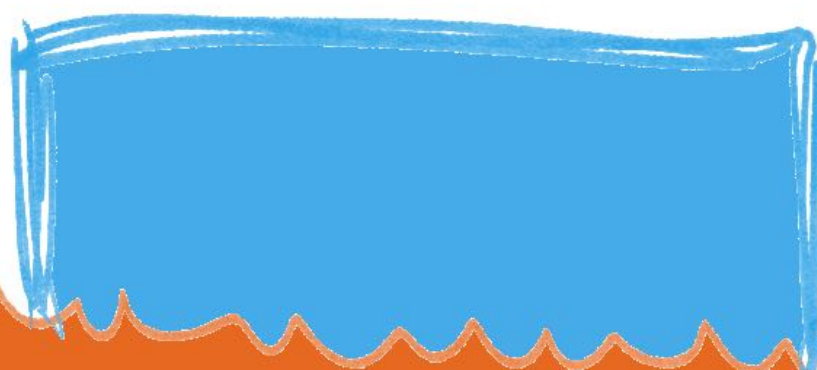
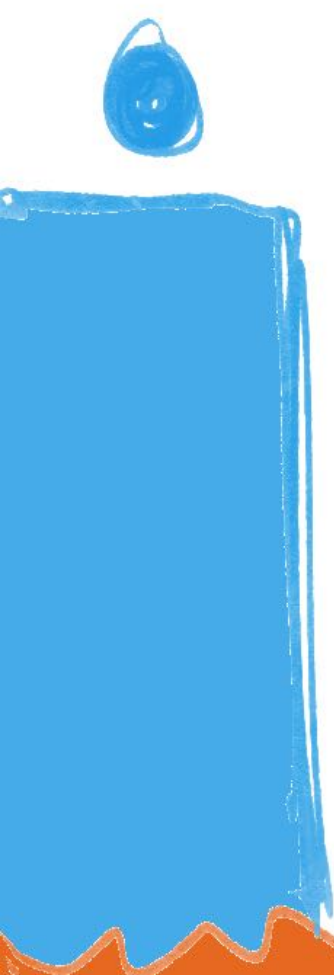
doesn't come with you
you must find it in this world
stone

new item



block that stops orb from
rolling

use plank and block

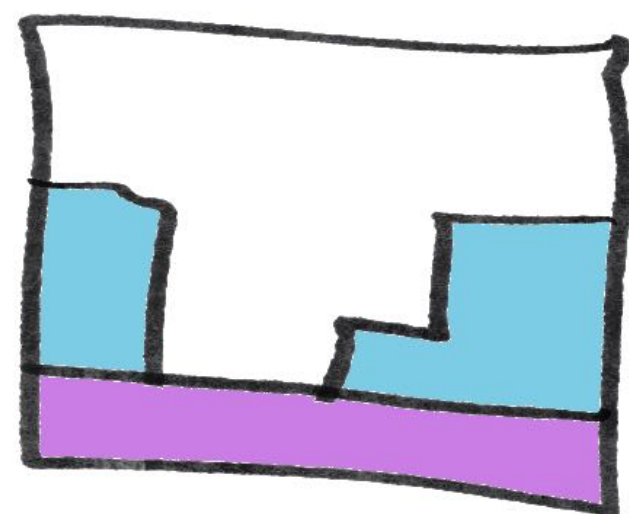
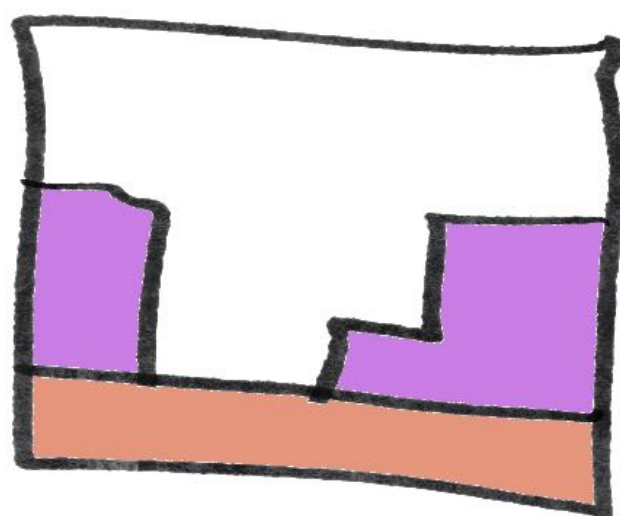
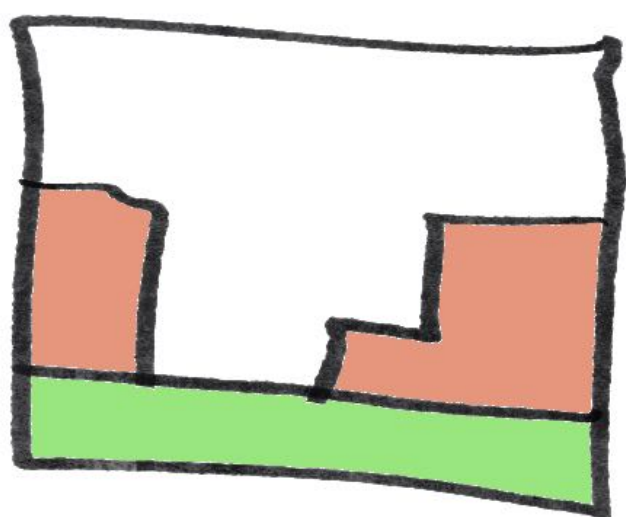
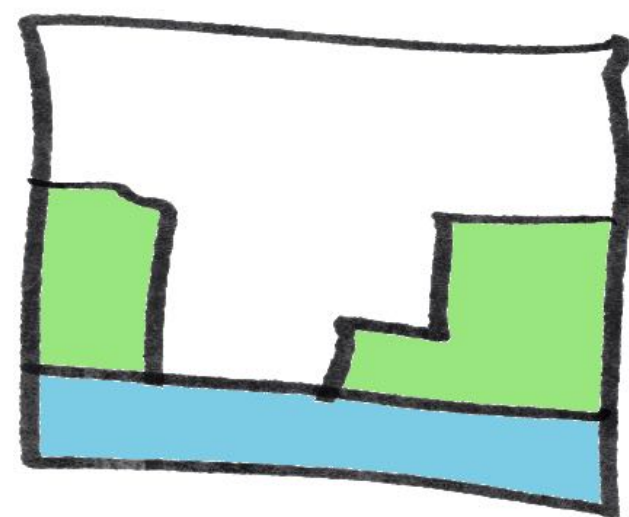
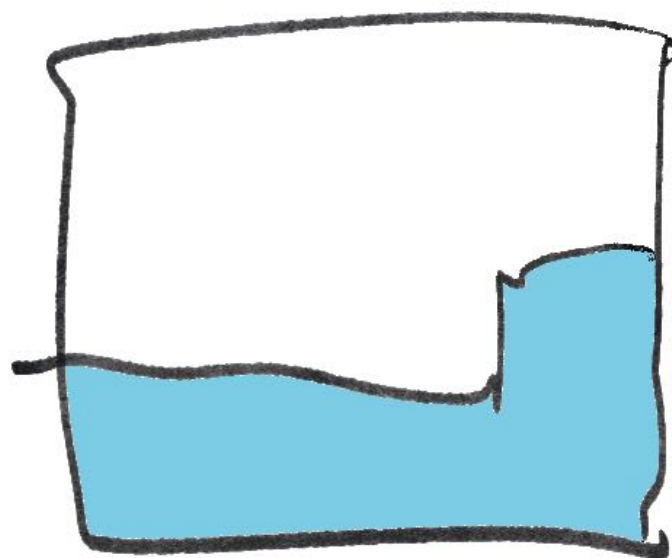
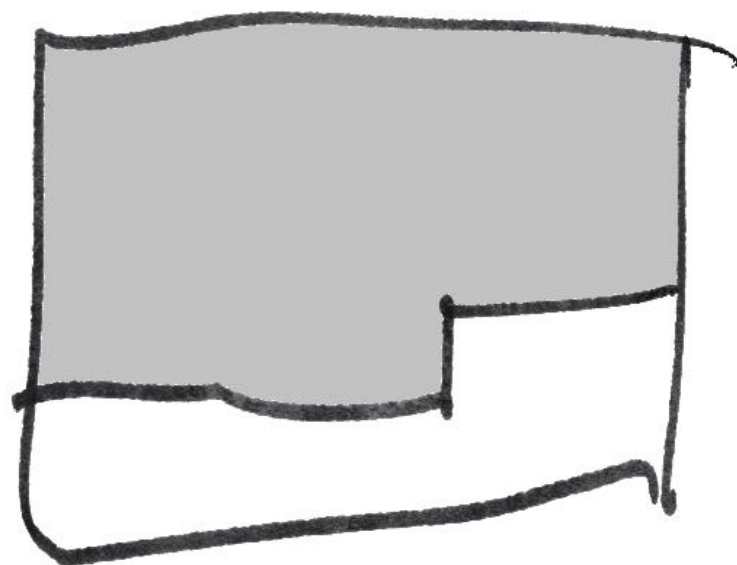


orange becomes water / lava



monster
in the
water

may become water/love



+ etradic palette works
nicely

what is the end goal or state?
what is the story?

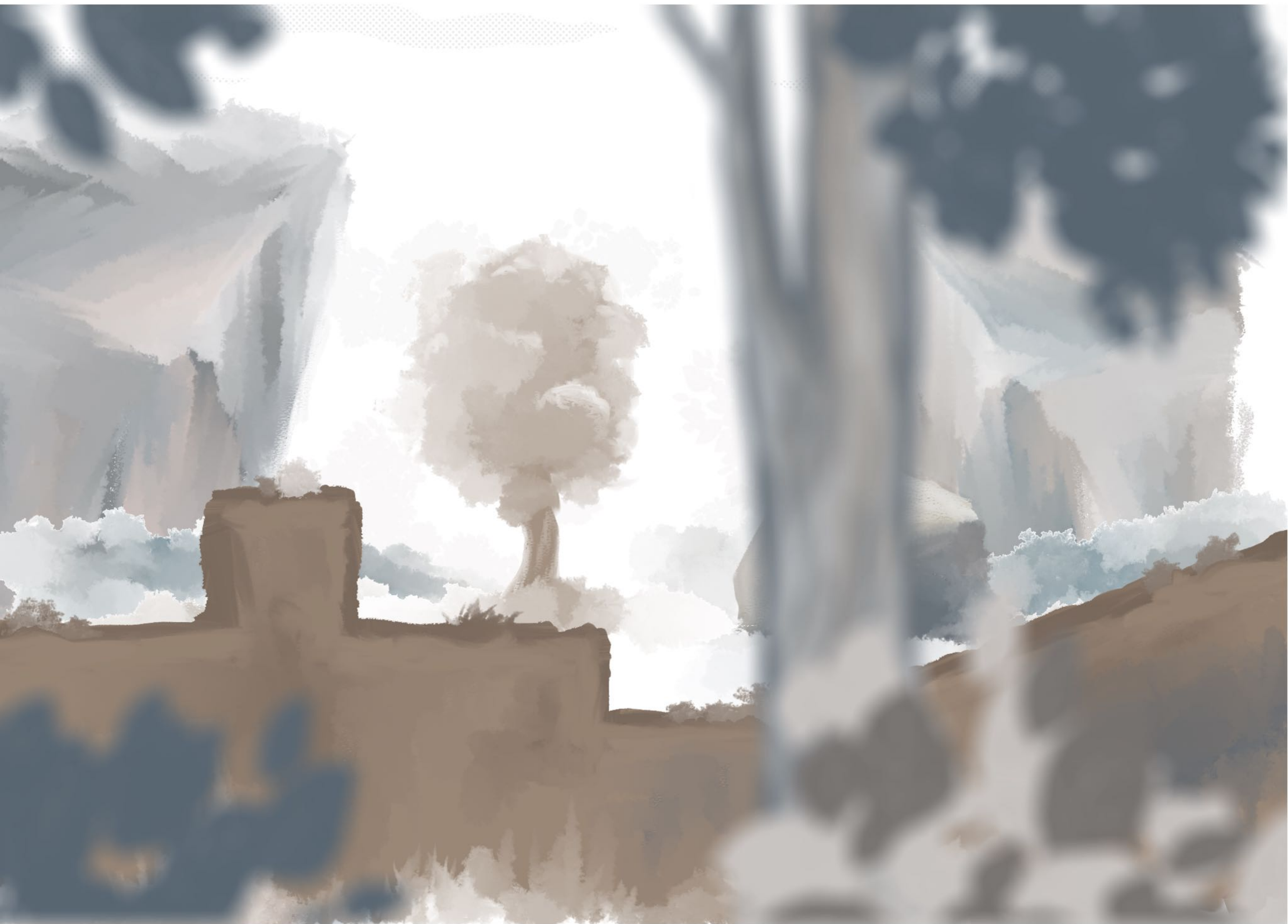
Skill/item progression

- movement
- plank to get up hill
- plank + stone to stop rolling
- plank + stone as fulcrum to launch
- lift to reach higher
- lift to drop stone on monster
- warp to cross wider gaps or tougher terrain

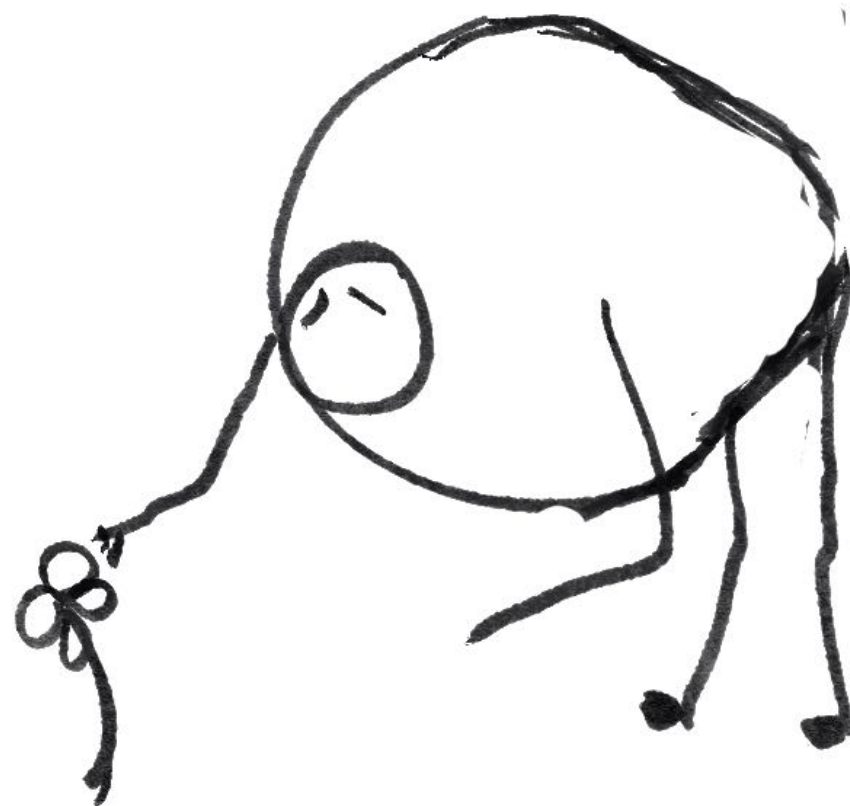
Tasks / skills

- story
- monster design x5
- puzzle design x6
- environment painting (tilesets, etc) x6
- music (diff styles per world?) x7
- sfx
- programming device mechanics/physics^{x4}
- programming monster mechanics
- character animation
- menus
- title screen
- beginning / ending cutscene
- UI/HUD
- credits screen

Painted art style



A hand-drawn sketch of a landscape. On the left, there is a small structure with a chimney, with the note "sickly green gray water" written below it. In the center, a fish is jumping out of the water, with the note "splash when walking" written below it. To the right of the fish is a large circle. Further right is a hill with the note "smoke? rain?" written on it. On the far right, there is a line representing a path or boundary, with the note "movement" written below it.





is there a gap?
a missing orb?

creatures to
reside in each
world?